

DIPLOMA IN EDUCATION PROGRAMME
SCHOOL OF EDUCATION
THE UNIVERSITY OF THE WEST INDIES, ST. AUGUSTINE

MUSIC

LESSON PLAN: #1 in Unit plan

TEACHER: Ms. Samantha Joseph **SCHOOL:** St. Joseph's Convent San Fernando

CLASS/FORM: Form 4 No. in class: 8 No of period(s): 2 Duration: 70 mins

Planning for the lesson

UNIT PLAN: From Listener to Arranger: Creating and Performing a Calypso Arrangement

TOPIC: Introduction to Calypso – What makes calypso sound like calypso? (cultural context and musical characteristics)

CONCEPT map /graphic organizer of knowledge required for lesson or Unit (to be attached separately):
See the attached Calypso: Musical + Cultural Context concept map. This lesson addresses the first branch, Listening & Context (rhythm, syncopation, melody, harmony, timbre, texture, form and expression), which is the foundation for every later stage of the unit

CURRICULUM INTEGRATION AREAS across subjects and materials needed

- Social Studies: the origins of calypso in Trinidad and Tobago (kaiso, the chantwell, Carnival and the calypso tent) and its role as social and political commentary.
- Language Arts: storytelling, humour and commentary in calypso lyrics; using precise descriptive vocabulary in oral and written responses.
- Mathematics: metre and subdivision – grouping eight quavers as 3 + 3 + 2 to feel the calypso accent pattern.

Materials: laptop, projector and speakers; recordings (listed under Resources); "Calypso Detective Case File" listening guide; comparison chart; context cards A–D; C/R/S response cards; whiteboard and markers; exit tickets; observation checklist.

The lesson plan:

PRE-KNOWLEDGE required (what knowledge/experiences do students bring to this lesson?)

- Students can name and define the elements of music (rhythm, melody, harmony, timbre, texture, form, dynamics, tempo) from Forms 1–3.
- They can recognise common instruments by sound and distinguish monophonic and homophonic textures at a basic level.
- They have informal experience of calypso, soca and reggae from home, Carnival, radio and school events, but may not yet be able to describe what they hear in musical terms.
- They can keep a steady beat and clap simple rhythms.

Strategies

Main pedagogical strategy: Guided discovery (inquiry-based learning) . Instead of being told what calypso is, students investigate the inquiry question "What makes calypso sound like calypso?" The teacher structures the investigation through carefully chosen contrasting recordings, a listening guide and probing questions, so that students form hypotheses, gather evidence, test their ideas and construct their own definition. The lesson follows an inquiry cycle: engage (set induction), explore (Section 1), investigate and compare (Section 2), and explain and apply (Section 3).

Supporting strategies: open and probing teacher questioning, active listening, cooperative small groups ("detective squads"), body-percussion imitation, think-pair-share and peer feedback.

Goals

At the end of this lesson/Unit, pupils will be able to

- Identify and analyse the musical characteristics of calypso through active listening (CSEC LIAP – Listening and Appraising).
- Use appropriate musical terminology to describe music and relate it to its cultural context (CSEC LIAP – Music Literacy and Perception).
- Develop appreciation of calypso as a significant Caribbean musical expression.
- HFLE (Self and Interpersonal Relationships): listen actively, communicate respectfully and cooperate in group work; develop a positive sense of cultural identity.

Objectives of the lesson	Classification of objectives	Domain
1. Identify at least three musical characteristics of calypso (e.g. rhythm, instrumentation, texture, structure) through listening to selected recordings.	Knowledge	Cognitive
2. Distinguish calypso from reggae and soca by comparing at least two musical elements in each example.	Analysis	Cognitive
3. Explain, using appropriate musical terminology, how one cultural function of calypso (storytelling, social commentary or Carnival) is reflected in its musical features.	Comprehension	Cognitive
4. Perform the calypso 3 + 3 + 2 accent pattern in body percussion while maintaining a steady pulse against a recording.	Imitation	Psychomotor
5. Show respect for different musical perspectives by listening to and building on peers' ideas during squad discussion.	Responding	Affective

SET INDUCTION – Time allotted: 6 minutes

"Mystery Sounds"

- The teacher plays three unlabelled 30-second excerpts: Calypso Rose, "Fire in Meh Wire" (calypso); Bob Marley, "Three Little Birds" (reggae); and Arrow, "Hot Hot Hot" (soca).
- After each excerpt, students hold up a C, R or S card to show whether they think it is calypso, reggae or soca. Calypso and soca are often confused, which creates a genuine puzzle for the class.
- The teacher does not confirm the answers. Instead, she asks, "How did you decide? What did you hear?" and records students' ideas as hypotheses on the board under the inquiry question, written in large letters: "What makes calypso sound like calypso?"
- The teacher frames the lesson: "Today you are music detectives. By the end of the lesson you will have the evidence to answer this question yourselves."

SECTION 1- Time allotted: **15 minutes (Explore: gathering evidence through guided listening)**
Teaching points:

- Calypso typically has a duple feel (2/4 or cut-time) at a moderate to brisk dance tempo.
- Its accompaniment is syncopated: guitar or cuatro strumming, bass and percussion often accent the pattern that groups eight quavers as 3 + 3 + 2.
- Typical instrumentation: lead voice (the calypsonian), horn section (trumpet, saxophone, trombone), guitar and/or cuatro, bass, drum kit and hand percussion.
- The texture is mainly homophonic (melody and accompaniment), with horn riffs and call-and-response between the singer and the horns or chorus.
- The form is usually verse–chorus (strophic), with an instrumental introduction and instrumental breaks between verses.
- Lyrics are central (storytelling, wit and social commentary), so the melody is clear and the words are easy to hear.

METHOD

Teaching Strategy	Student Activity	Resources
Guided listening. The teacher plays Lord Kitchener, "London Is the Place for Me" twice. First listening: open response – "What do you notice?" Second listening: the teacher directs attention one element at a time with probing questions, e.g. "Tap the pulse – does it feel like groups of two, three or four?" "Which instrument answers the singer?" "Do the strong accents fall on the beat or between beats?"	Students listen and record observations in the Case File under each element: pulse/metre, rhythm, instrumentation/timbre, texture, structure, expression and lyrics. They tap the pulse and raise a hand each time the horns answer the voice.	• Recording: Lord Kitchener, "London Is the Place for Me" • Speakers • "Calypso Detective Case File" listening guide
Small-group investigation. The teacher plays Calypso Rose, "Fire in Meh Wire" in full. Squads (4–5 students) check whether the clues from the first song appear again. The teacher circulates and asks probing questions instead of giving answers, e.g. "What is your evidence for that?" "Is that true for both songs?"	Each squad member takes responsibility for one or two elements. Squads compare observations from both songs and highlight the "repeated clues" that appear in both.	• Recording: Calypso Rose, "Fire in Meh Wire" • Case File • Highlighters

SECTIONAL REVIEW and feedback (formative assessment strategies) Time allotted: 3 minutes (within Section 1)

- Each squad adds one "repeated clue" to the class clue board, rotating so that every element is covered.
- The teacher questions to sharpen terminology (e.g. "You said the music sounds 'busy' – which musical term describes that texture?") and corrects misconceptions.
- Quick confidence check: thumbs up, sideways or down for identifying each element.

SECTION 2 – Time allotted: 22 minutes (Investigate: testing the clues against other Caribbean styles and context)

Teaching points:

- Calypso vs reggae: reggae is slower, with off-beat "skank" chords on beats 2 and 4 and a prominent, melodic bass. Calypso is brisker and is driven by the 3 + 3 + 2 syncopated accompaniment.
- Calypso vs soca: soca developed out of calypso in the 1970s (pioneered by Lord Shorty). It is generally faster and designed for fetes and road marches, with heavier, driving percussion and electronic sounds, and lyrics that focus on partying rather than storytelling or commentary.
- Cultural context: calypso developed in Trinidad from the kaiso tradition of enslaved Africans, the chantwell who led Carnival bands, and the calypso tents. It became the "people's newspaper". Women such as Calypso Rose broke into what was a male-dominated art form.
- Musical features reflect function: storytelling → clear melody and audible lyrics; Carnival and dance → steady, syncopated rhythm; the chantwell tradition → call-and-response.

METHOD

Teaching Strategy	Student Activity	Resources
Contrasting examples. The teacher replays the reggae and soca excerpts from the set induction and poses the guiding question: "Which of our clues are found only in calypso?" She prompts comparison of tempo, rhythm and accent, bass, instrumentation and lyrical focus.	Students complete the comparison chart (calypso | reggae | soca) for four elements. They decide which clues on the board are true only of calypso and strike out the clues that are shared.	• Excerpts: "Three Little Birds" and "Hot Hot Hot" • Comparison chart • Clue board

Feel the difference (body-percussion imitation). The teacher models the calypso pattern: stamp the pulse (two beats per bar) and clap the accents on quavers 1, 4 and 7 (3 + 3 + 2). She then models the reggae off-beat skank (clap on beats 2 and 4 against a slower pulse). The class performs each pattern over the matching recording.	Students imitate, then perform both patterns over the recordings. In pairs, they describe how the two patterns feel different and which rhythm "drives" the music forward.	• Recordings • Rhythm shown on the board in graphic and staff notation • Open floor space
Context cards ("Why does calypso sound like this?"). Each squad receives one card: (A) kaiso and the chantwell; (B) Carnival and the calypso tent; (C) calypso as the people's newspaper; (D) women in calypso – Calypso Rose. The teacher asks: "How might this history explain one of the musical clues on our board?"	Squads read the card and link at least one cultural or historical fact to a musical feature (e.g. storytelling → clear melody and audible lyrics). Each squad shares its link with the class.	• Context cards A–D

SECTIONAL REVIEW and feedback (formative assessment strategies) Time allotted: 4 minutes (within Section 2)

- "Name that style" quick quiz: the teacher plays 10-second clips and students show C, R or S cards. Selected students justify their answers with one musical clue.
- The teacher uses the observation checklist during body percussion to record steady pulse and accurate accents (Objective 4).

SECTION 3 – Time allotted: 12 minutes (Explain and apply: constructing and testing a definition)

Teaching points:

- A musical style is identified by a combination of features, not by any single feature.
- Calypso identity profile: duple metre; syncopated 3 + 3 + 2 accompaniment; horns, guitar/cuatro, bass and percussion; homophonic texture with call-and-response; verse–chorus form with instrumental breaks; lyrics that tell stories or comment on society.
- Key terminology: syncopation, ostinato, homophonic, call-and-response, strophic/verse–chorus, timbre.

METHOD

Teaching Strategy	Student Activity	Resources
Constructing a definition (think-pair-share → squad). The teacher asks each squad to write a "Calypso Identity Profile" of 3–4 sentences using at least five musical terms and one cultural link. She confers briefly with squads, prompting with questions such as: "Could a soca song also fit your profile? How would you change it?"	Students think individually, share with a partner, then agree on a squad profile. They check the profile against their comparison chart and refine the wording.	• Profile template / mini whiteboards • Word bank of musical terms
Testing the profile on a new case. The teacher plays an unseen calypso: David Rudder, "Calypso Music". Squads test whether their profile holds and identify any features it does not yet cover.	Students tick off the features in their profile that they hear and adjust the profile where necessary. One squad reads its final profile aloud; the class responds with one "glow" and one "grow".	• Recording: David Rudder, "Calypso Music" • Squad profiles

SECTIONAL REVIEW and feedback (formative assessment strategies) Time allotted: 3 minutes (within Section 3)

- Peer feedback (glow and grow) on the squad profile that was read aloud.
- Teacher questioning on terminology; the teacher affirms an agreed class profile on the board.

CLOSURE (How will you end the lesson?)– Time allotted: 5 minutes

- The teacher returns to the inquiry question on the board. The class combines the squad profiles into one shared Calypso Identity Statement.
- Students compare the statement with their opening hypotheses from the "Mystery Sounds" activity: which were confirmed, which were rejected and why?
- The teacher links the lesson to the concept map and to Lesson 2: "Rhythm was one of our strongest clues. Next lesson we become rhythm makers and create our own calypso ostinatos."

FINAL EVALUATION – Time allotted: 10 minutes

Reasonable level of achievement: at least 80% of students score 7 out of 10 or higher, and at least 80% are rated "satisfactory" or better for body percussion on the observation checklist.

Exit ticket (individual):

- Q1 (listening): Two short excerpts are played – X: Mighty Sparrow, "Dan Is the Man in the Van" (calypso); Y: Bunji Garlin, "Differentology" (soca). Which excerpt is calypso? Give one musical reason. (2 marks)
- Q2: Name three musical characteristics of calypso, using correct musical terms. (3 marks)
- Q3: Explain how one musical feature of calypso is connected to its cultural role. (3 marks)
- Body-percussion performance from Section 2, recorded on the observation checklist. (2 marks)
- Unmarked reflection: "One thing I now appreciate about calypso is…"

Objective 5 is assessed through the teacher's observation checklist during squad work.

Table of Specification

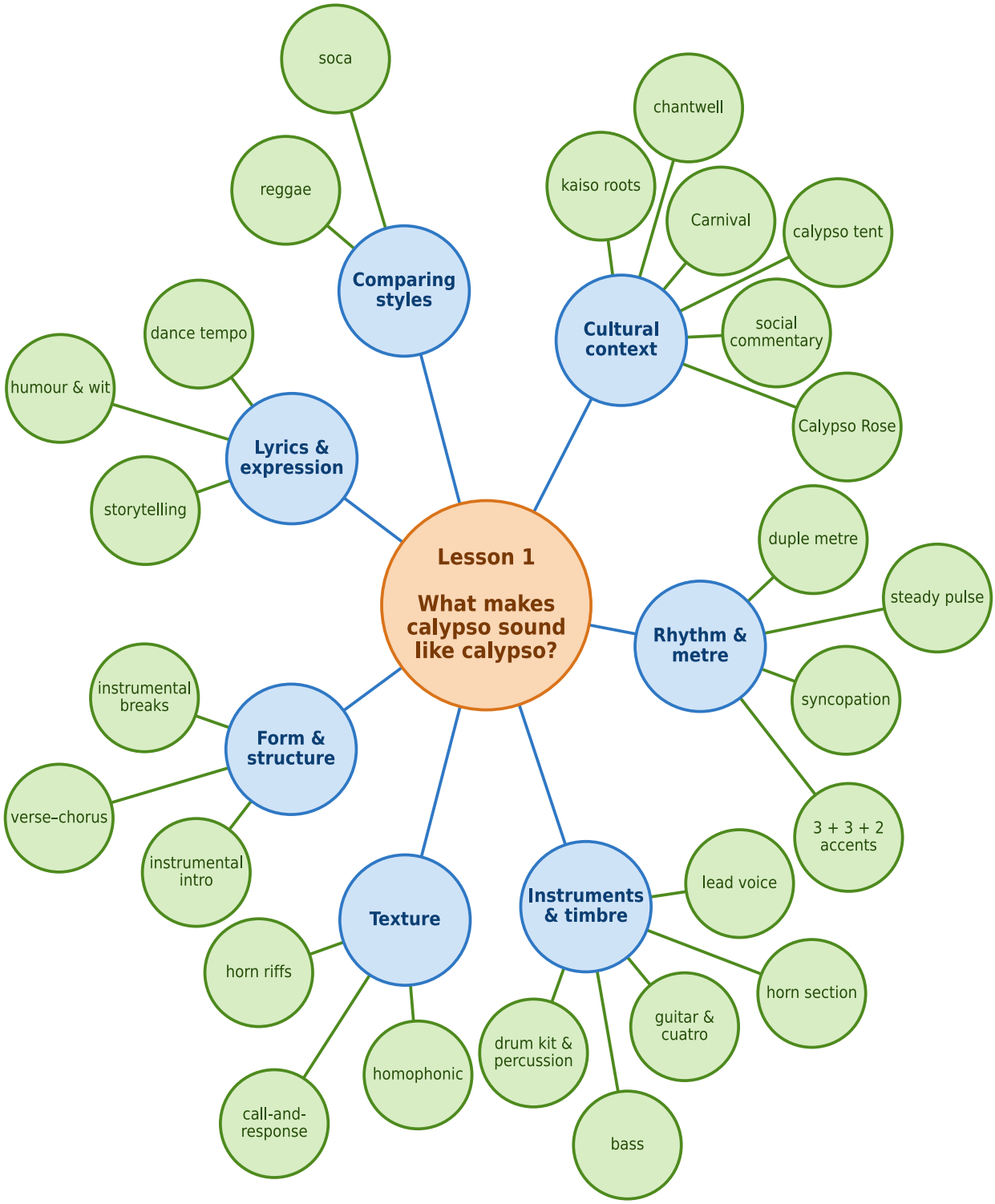
Objective	Assessment Item	Domain/Level	Marks	% of total
1. Identify characteristics of calypso	Exit ticket Q2	Cognitive – Knowledge	3	30%
2. Distinguish calypso from reggae and soca	Exit ticket Q1	Cognitive – Analysis	2	20%
3. Explain the link between cultural function and musical features	Exit ticket Q3	Cognitive – Comprehension	3	30%
4. Perform the 3 + 3 + 2 pattern with a steady pulse	Observation checklist (Section 2)	Psychomotor – Imitation	2	20%
5. Respect peers' musical ideas	Observation checklist (squad work) and unmarked reflection	Affective – Responding	-	-
Total			**10**	**100%**

Marks for Q1: 1 for correct identification, 1 for a valid musical reason. Q3: 1 for the musical feature, 1 for the cultural role, 1 for a clear link between them.

FOLLOW-UP ACTIVITIES/LESSON:

- Home task – "Calypso in my home": interview a family member or neighbour about a calypso they remember. Bring the song title, the calypsonian and one musical clue you can hear when you listen to it. These songs will build a class calypso playlist used in later lessons.
- Next lesson (Lesson 2 – Rhythmic Identity of Calypso): students build on the 3 + 3 + 2 pattern to create and layer their own rhythmic ostinatos.

Concept Map:


Lesson 1
What makes calypso sound like calypso?
Comparing styles
soca
reggae
Cultural context
chantwell
kaiso roots
Carnival
calypso tent
social commentary
Calypso Rose
Lyrics & expression
dance tempo
humour & wit
storytelling
Rhythm & metre
duple metre
steady pulse
syncopation
3 + 3 + 2 accents
Form & structure
instrumental breaks
verse–chorus
instrumental intro
Texture
horn riffs
homophonic
call-and-response
Instruments & timbre
lead voice
horn section
guitar & cuatro
drum kit & percussion
bass